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Interviews

Interviews are a qualitative research method used to explore users’ needs, motivations, experiences, and expectations through structured or semi-structured conversations.

Phase: **User Research** Effort level: **Medium**

Article

Links

Conducting the interview

During the interview, the focus should be on creating a setting that supports open and honest reflection.

- Create a comfortable, non-judgmental environment and clearly explain the purpose of the session
- Obtain explicit consent before recording audio or video, and clarify how recordings and notes will be used
- Listen actively and allow pauses, giving participants time to think and respond
- Ask follow-up questions when clarification or concrete examples are needed
- Focus on experiences, behaviors, and real situations rather than abstract opinions

When recording is used, it should support attentive listening rather than replace engagement. Notes and recordings are tools for later analysis, not substitutes for active participation during the conversation.

The interviewer’s role is to facilitate reflection, not to confirm assumptions or steer participants toward expected answers.

Common pitfalls

- Asking leading or biased questions
- Interviewing only internal stakeholders
- Treating individual statements as universal truths
- Skipping documentation and synthesis
- Being aware of these pitfalls helps improve validity and reliability.

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Types of interviews

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After the interview

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